My Books

A book is like a friend. Dr Seuss, a very well-known writer of children's books, has said:

The more that you read, the more things you will know.
The more that you learn, the more places you'll go.

Let us read about how we can go to different places with books.

I love my books.
They are the homes
Of queens and fairies,
Knights and gnomes.

Each time I read, I make a call
On some quaint person, large or small,
Who welcomes me with hearty hand,
And leads me through his wonderland.

Each book is like
A city street
Along whose winding
Way I meet
New friends and old who laugh and sing,
And take me off adventuring!

knights: soldiers who rode horses and fought battles a long time ago gnomes: tiny men with pointed hats who are believed to live underground and guard Earth's treasures make a call: visit quaint: strange hearty: warm-hearted; friendly winding: having a lot of bends and turns adventuring: doing new and exciting things, often in new places

In this section, we will:
- identify and interpret the central ideas of a poem.
- recognize relevant details to answer questions based on the poem.
(C-2.1, C-2.2)

Make connections

Answer the following questions based on the poem.

1. Name two things that books have been compared to in the poem.
2. In the poem, find
   a. the opposite of the word 'usual'. _____
   b. a synonym of the word 'twisting'. _____
3. Read these lines and answer the questions that follow.

   I love my books.
   They are the homes
   Of queens and fairies,
   Knights and gnomes.

   a. How did the narrator feel about books?
   b. List the characters that the poet had read about.
   c. What kind of books do you think the poet has described in these lines? Name one such book that you have read.

4. Pick out five rhyming pairs of words from the poem.
5. How is reading a book similar to having an adventure?
6. What books do you enjoy reading? If you met someone who did not read books, what would you say to encourage the person to read?

In this section, we will:
- learn to differentiate between a simile and a metaphor.
(C-2.2)

Appreciation

Similes and metaphors

Read these comparisons.

- Each book is like a city street …
- They (books) are the homes of queens and fairies …

The first comparison says that a book is like a city street.
This comparison is a simile.

> A simile is a word or a group of words that compares one thing to something else, using the words 'like' or 'as'.

The second comparison says that books are the homes of queens and fairies.
This comparison is a metaphor.

A metaphor is a word or a group of words that says one thing *is* something else, and not just *like* it. A metaphor is a stronger comparison than a simile.

Similes and metaphors make poetry more interesting by creating vivid pictures and images in our minds.

1. Identify the type of comparisons in these lines. Underline the similes and circle the metaphors.

a. The paintbrush was like a magic wand in the hand of the artist.

b. My sister is a walking dictionary. She knows the meaning of every word that I ask her.

c. I work all week but on Sundays I am as free as a bird.

d. He is a night owl. He stays awake all night and sleeps all day.

e. When my grandmother sees me, she smiles and says, "You are my sunshine!"

2. Use a simile and a metaphor to write descriptive sentences for each of the pictures given below.

a.

b.

c.

d.